

BLOODROSE

Contractor Contract

Governed Production Seed — Version 0.1

Project: Bloodrose

Version: v0.1

Classification: Governed Production Seed

Issuing Authority: System Architect / Project Lead

Effective Date: April 21, 2026

Status: Active — Initial Phase

1. PROJECT OVERVIEW

Bloodrose is a dark fantasy romance narrative action browser game prototype. The player assumes the role of **Lady Isolde**, a betrayed bloodwitch trapped within her own living heart-garden—a surreal, crimson-lit landscape where thorns carry memory, roses bleed intention, and every step forward is a negotiation between corruption and self-reclamation. The prototype is built to prove that AI-assisted systems can transform narrative concepts into playable interactive experiences with explicit state, governed rules, emotional mechanics, and deterministic progression.

Bloodrose is not a toy demo. It is a **governed production seed**—a foundational artifact designed to establish the standards, constraints, and

canonical authority that will govern all future development. Every contribution to this project, whether a single sprite, a line of dialogue, or a state management function, must meet production-grade standards even at prototype scale. Work that is "good enough for now" is not good enough. The seed determines the shape of the tree.

The project exists within a broader pipeline that includes future modular architecture, cross-media adaptation potential, and integration with the **Story Forge** system—an AI-assisted narrative production engine.

Contributors to Bloodrose are not simply building a game; they are establishing the precedent for how governed creative-technical projects operate under canonical authority. This contract defines the terms under which that contribution occurs.

2. SCOPE OF ENGAGEMENT

Contractors engaged under this agreement may be assigned work within one or more of the following categories. Each engagement will be accompanied by a scoped engagement brief that identifies specific deliverables, acceptance criteria, and canonical constraints applicable to that assignment.

2.1 Development Work

- Game logic implementation, including state management, event processing, movement systems, and collision detection
- UI/UX implementation, including meters (corruption, redemption), the narrative log, and win/lose screen flows
- Performance optimization and cross-browser compatibility assurance
- Integration of game systems with the canonical event processing pipeline

2.2 Creative Work

- Visual asset creation, including sprites, tilesets, environmental art, and UI elements
- Narrative writing, including dialogue, narrative log entries, and ending text
- Audio and sound design, including ambient soundscapes, event-triggered audio cues, and atmospheric scoring

2.3 Architecture Work

- Modular system design, including entity separation, event bus architecture, and render layer abstraction
- Governed pipeline tooling, including drift detection harnesses and validation systems
- Documentation and specification work, including canonical spec maintenance and technical writing

NOTICE

Each engagement category must reference the specific deliverables, acceptance criteria, and canonical constraints outlined in this contract. No work may proceed without a scoped engagement brief approved by the System Architect.

3. CANONICAL COMPLIANCE REQUIREMENTS

This section constitutes the governing authority of the contract. All other provisions are subordinate to the requirements defined here. Canonical compliance is not optional, aspirational, or subject to creative interpretation. It is the condition under which work is accepted.

3.1 Single Source of Truth

- 3.1.1 The **Bloodrose Canonical Spec v0.1** is the sole governing document for all design decisions. It defines the mechanics, state variables, narrative parameters, and aesthetic constraints of the project.
- 3.1.2 The **Canonical Event Table** is the authoritative registry of all game events. No event may exist in the game that does not have a corresponding, fully documented entry in this table.
- 3.1.3 No event, mechanic, state variable, or narrative output may be introduced that is not directly traceable to a canonical document. Traceability means a specific section, clause, or entry can be cited as the authorizing source.
- 3.1.4 **“Suggestion is not truth.”** A contractor’s interpretation, creative impulse, or professional opinion does not override the spec. If a contractor believes the spec is incorrect or incomplete, the Amendment Process (Section 9) must be followed. Unilateral deviation is drift.

3.2 State Integrity

- 3.2.1 All state variables—including but not limited to **corruption**, **redemption**, **score**, **game_over**, and **ending_type**—must behave exactly as defined in the Canonical Spec. No approximation, reinterpretation, or “functionally equivalent” substitution is permitted.

3.2.2 State transitions must be **deterministic**. Given identical inputs and conditions, the same state transition must produce the same result every time. No random modifiers, probabilistic triggers, or stochastic elements are permitted in v0.1.

3.2.3 No hidden state may be introduced without an explicit spec amendment. Every variable that influences game behavior must be visible in the canonical state model.

3.2.4 The following invariants are absolute and may not be violated under any implementation:

- (a) Corruption must never decrease through thorn contact;
- (b) Thorn contact must never increase redemption; and
- (c) Thorn contact must never directly trigger a win state.

3.3 Event Governance

3.3.1 Every event in the game must have a corresponding entry in the Canonical Event Table. Events without table entries are unauthorized and constitute drift.

3.3.2 Events fire only when their documented trigger conditions are met. No event may fire preemptively, speculatively, or “for dramatic effect” outside its defined trigger window.

3.3.3 Terminal events (Priority 0) override all other simultaneous events. When a terminal event’s conditions are met, it takes absolute precedence.

3.3.4 Threshold events fire only on first crossing of their defined threshold unless explicitly marked as repeatable in the Event Table.

3.3.5 There are no “flavor events.” Every event must be condition-based and state-justified. Atmospheric or decorative events that lack mechanical grounding are not permitted.

3.4 Narrative Integrity

- 3.4.1** All narrative output must match the emotional tone defined in the Canonical Spec. The tonal axis of Bloodrose encompasses: **betrayal, fragmentation, toxic desire, rage, guilt, mercy, and self-reclamation**. Narrative that falls outside this axis is unauthorized.
- 3.4.2** **Lady Isolde** is a fixed dramatic identity. Contractors must not rewrite her character, alter her motivations, shift her emotional axis, or reduce her to a generic protagonist. She is specific. She stays specific.
- 3.4.3** The **Heart-Garden** is symbolic but mechanically legible. Its atmosphere is expressive; its logic is explicit. Contractors must maintain this duality—the garden is both a place of feeling and a system of rules.
- 3.4.4** No generic fantasy action game tropes. Bloodrose is not a dungeon crawler, a hack-and-slash, or a power fantasy. Every mechanic must serve the emotional frame. If a mechanic does not advance the themes of the narrative, it does not belong.

3.5 Aesthetic Compliance

- 3.5.1** All visual work must adhere to the canonical aesthetic: **crimson, black, moonlit, gothic, surreal romantic horror**. The visual language of Bloodrose is blood-red roses, living thorns, candlelit ruin, heartbreak made physical, beauty mixed with danger.
- 3.5.2** The following are expressly prohibited: bright or cheerful color palettes, cartoon or chibi art styles, tonal mismatches with the gothic romantic horror aesthetic, and any visual treatment that undermines the gravity of the narrative.
- 3.5.3** Audio and sound design, where applicable, must be **orchestral, tragic, and intimate**. Upbeat scoring, action-game soundtracks, electronic dance music, and tonally incongruent audio are not permitted.

4. DELIVERABLE STANDARDS

4.1 Code Deliverables

- 4.1.1 All code must be clean, commented, and readable. Variable names must be descriptive. Functions must be documented with their purpose, parameters, and return values.
- 4.1.2 State management must be **explicit**. No implicit side effects. Every function that modifies state must do so transparently and traceably. State changes must be auditable.
- 4.1.3 Event processing must follow the priority system defined in the Canonical Event Table. The implementation must respect Priority 0 override behavior and threshold-crossing rules.
- 4.1.4 **Browser compatibility:** All code must run in modern browsers (Chrome, Firefox, Edge, Safari) without plugins, extensions, or nonstandard APIs.
- 4.1.5 Phase 1 deliverables must conform to **single-file HTML prototype format**. Modular architecture applies to Phase 2 and beyond. No external dependencies may be introduced without prior written approval from the System Architect.

4.2 Asset Deliverables

- 4.2.1 All visual assets must be delivered in specified formats: PNG for sprites and tilesets; SVG for UI elements where applicable. Format requirements will be confirmed in the engagement brief.
- 4.2.2 All assets must be **original work** or properly licensed. No unlicensed third-party content, no AI-generated assets without disclosure and approval, and no assets whose provenance cannot be verified.

4.2.3 Naming conventions must follow project standards as provided in the engagement brief. Assets delivered with non-conforming names will be returned for correction.

4.2.4 All assets must be optimized for browser performance. Oversized, uncompressed, or inefficiently formatted assets will not be accepted.

4.3 Documentation Deliverables

4.3.1 All documentation must be versioned with clear version numbers and dates. Unversioned documentation will not be accepted into the canonical pipeline.

4.3.2 Specifications must use the governed format established by the project. Contractors will receive format templates with their engagement brief.

4.3.3 No undocumented features, mechanics, or behaviors. If it exists in the deliverable, it must exist in the documentation. Undocumented functionality is treated as drift.

5. ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

A deliverable is considered complete and accepted only when **all** of the following conditions are satisfied:

#	Criterion	Applies To
AC-1	Deliverable matches the scope defined in the engagement brief. No more, no less.	All
AC-2	All state transitions are deterministic and traceable to canonical documents.	Code
AC-3	No unauthorized	All

#	Criterion	Applies To
	events, mechanics, state variables, or narrative elements are present.	
AC-4	Code passes quality review: readable, no dead code, properly commented, no implicit side effects.	Code
AC-5	Assets meet aesthetic compliance standards as defined in Section 3.5.	Assets
AC-6	Documentation is complete, versioned, and formatted per project standards.	Docs
AC-7	The System Architect or designated reviewer signs off on the deliverable.	All

No deliverable is merged into the production pipeline without satisfying AC-7. Reviewer sign-off is the final gate.

6. GOVERNANCE GATES

Work on Bloodrose proceeds through a series of mandatory checkpoints. These gates are not bureaucratic formalities—they are the structural mechanism by which canonical integrity is maintained across contributors.

6.1 Pre-Work Gate

Before commencing any work, the Contractor must complete the following:

6.1.1 Confirm receipt and understanding of the **Bloodrose Canonical Spec v0.1**.

- 6.1.2** Confirm receipt and understanding of the **Canonical Event Table**.
- 6.1.3** Acknowledge this Contractor Contract by signature (Section 13).
- 6.1.4** Receive a **scoped engagement brief** for the specific deliverables assigned, including acceptance criteria, timeline, and canonical constraints relevant to the engagement.

MANDATORY

No work product will be reviewed or accepted from a contractor who has not cleared the Pre-Work Gate. This gate is non-negotiable.

6.2 Mid-Work Review

- 6.2.1** For any engagement exceeding **five (5) working days**, a mid-point review is required. The contractor must present work-in-progress for a canonical compliance check.
- 6.2.2** Drift detected at this stage must be corrected before the contractor proceeds with remaining work. The mid-point review is a course-correction opportunity, not a formality.
- 6.2.3** The System Architect may require additional interim reviews at their discretion for complex or high-risk engagements.

6.3 Final Acceptance Gate

- 6.3.1** The completed deliverable is submitted for formal review against the acceptance criteria defined in Section 5.
- 6.3.2** The System Architect or designated reviewer conducts a **canonical compliance audit**, verifying traceability, state integrity, event governance, narrative integrity, and aesthetic compliance as applicable.
- 6.3.3** **Approved deliverables** are merged into the production pipeline and logged in the project's version history.

6.3.4 Rejected deliverables receive documented feedback specifying the exact nature of non-compliance and the corrections required. The contractor must address all identified issues before resubmission.

7. DRIFT POLICY

7.1 “Drift” is defined as any deviation from canonical documents that was not pre-approved through the Amendment Process (Section 9). Drift is the primary threat to project integrity, and this contract treats it accordingly.

7.2 Drift includes, without limitation:

- (a) Unauthorized mechanics or gameplay systems;
- (b) Unapproved narrative tone shifts or character modifications;
- (c) Hidden state variables not present in the canonical state model;
- (d) Events without corresponding Canonical Event Table entries;
- (e) Aesthetic violations as defined in Section 3.5; and
- (f) Undocumented features, behaviors, or state modifications.

7.3 Drift detected during any review gate must be **corrected at the contractor’s expense** (time and effort). The project does not bear the cost of unauthorized deviation.

7.4 Repeated or willful drift constitutes a material breach of this contract and is grounds for immediate termination under Section 12.

7.5 The project maintains a **Drift Detection Harness** (a separate artifact) for automated compliance checking where applicable. Contractors should assume that their work will be subjected to automated validation in addition to manual review.

8. AMENDMENT PROCESS

The canonical documents are living instruments—but they change through governance, not impulse. The following process governs all modifications to canonical material.

8.1 No contractor may unilaterally modify, annotate, or extend any canonical document. The Canonical Spec and Event Table are controlled documents.

8.2 Proposed changes must be submitted as **formal amendment requests** to the System Architect. Verbal suggestions, inline code comments, or casual communications do not constitute amendment requests.

8.3 Each amendment request must include:

- (a) The proposed change, stated with specificity;
- (b) Justification for the change;
- (c) All affected state variables, events, and mechanics; and
- (d) An impact assessment describing downstream consequences.

8.4 Approved amendments are logged in the **Amendment Log** of the affected canonical document. Each entry must include:

Field	Description
Amendment ID	Unique sequential identifier (e.g., AMD-001)
Date	Date the amendment was approved
Description	Clear statement of what changed
Author	Who proposed the amendment
Approver	System Architect or designee who approved it

- 8.5** No work may rely on a proposed but unapproved amendment. Until an amendment is formally approved and logged, the existing canonical text governs.

9. INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

- 9.1** All work produced under this contract is **work-for-hire** and belongs exclusively to the Project. The Contractor assigns all rights, title, and interest in and to all deliverables upon creation.
- 9.2** The Contractor retains no rights to derivative works based on Bloodrose canonical material, including but not limited to characters, narrative content, game mechanics, architectural designs, and aesthetic frameworks.
- 9.3** The Contractor may reference the engagement in their professional portfolio only with **prior written approval** from the System Architect. Such references must not disclose confidential information as defined in Section 10.
- 9.4** No canonical material—including the Canonical Spec, Event Table, narrative content, or architecture documents—may be shared externally, reproduced, or distributed without express written authorization.

10. CONFIDENTIALITY

- 10.1** All canonical documents, architecture specifications, unreleased creative material, technical designs, and project communications are **confidential information** under this contract.
- 10.2** The Contractor must not disclose project details, mechanics, narrative content, technical architecture, or any other confidential information to third parties, whether in conversation, publication, social

media, portfolio presentations, or any other medium, except as expressly permitted under Section 9.3.

10.3 Confidentiality survives contract termination. The obligations defined in this section remain in full force and effect after the contract ends, regardless of the reason for termination.

11. TERMINATION CONDITIONS

11.1 Either party may terminate this contract with **fourteen (14) days' written notice** to the other party.

11.2 Immediate termination may be effected by the Project for any of the following causes:

- (a) Willful or repeated drift as defined in Section 7;
- (b) Violation of intellectual property provisions (Section 9);
- (c) Breach of confidentiality (Section 10); or
- (d) Failure to meet governance gates after documented feedback and a reasonable opportunity to cure.

11.3 Upon termination, the Contractor must **return or destroy** all canonical materials, project files, and confidential information as directed by the System Architect. All work product completed prior to termination remains the property of the Project.

12. GENERAL PROVISIONS

12.1 Independent Contractor. The Contractor is an independent contractor and not an employee, agent, or partner of the Project. Nothing in this contract creates an employment relationship.

12.2 Entire Agreement. This contract, together with the engagement brief and canonical documents referenced herein, constitutes the entire

agreement between the parties with respect to the subject matter hereof.

12.3 Severability. If any provision of this contract is found to be unenforceable, the remaining provisions shall continue in full force and effect.

12.4 Governing Authority. The System Architect is the final interpretive authority for all matters of canonical compliance, deliverable acceptance, and contract enforcement under this agreement.

13. SIGNATURES

By signing below, the parties acknowledge that they have read, understood, and agree to be bound by the terms and conditions set forth in this Contractor Contract, including all canonical compliance requirements, governance gates, and drift policies defined herein.

Contractor

Name / Entity: _____

Engagement ID: _____

Contractor Signature

Date: _____

System Architect / Project Lead

Name: _____

System Architect Signature

Date: _____

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This document is confidential and subject to the terms defined herein.